Japan Portfolio Brief — Monday, November 2, 2026

Covers the weekend and Friday Oct 30 close through the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Mon Nov 2. Positions are treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (continuing):*** *page fetches were blocked for most hosts (company IR, TDnet, DART, Kabutan, MOF, BoJ, Nikkei, Reuters), so everything comes from search-result snippets. Market-level numbers are mostly corroborated;* ***company-specific news for Oct 30–Nov 2 was found for only a handful of names****, and the Japan industrial, small-cap and bank threads returned essentially nothing. "QUIET" means "nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are aggregator-sourced or inferred from last year unless stated. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.*

---

1. Top of the stack

Korea's chip rebound: KOSPI +2.24% to 5,859.08, KOSDAQ +1.38% to 734.36, after Friday's AI-capex rout. The index opened near 5,600 (about -2% intraday), then reversed on large-cap semiconductors; foreigners sold and institutions bought more than ₩1.2tn (FN News, Invezz). SK hynix closed ₩1,472,000 (+3.81%) after -7.08% Friday; Samsung Electronics ₩229,000 (+1.78%) after -3.02%; SK Square +5.91% (Gukje News). The catalyst was the record October export print released Nov 1: $115.3bn (+93.7% y/y), chips $56.4bn (+259.4%) (Seoul Economic Daily, JoongAng). Book read-through: SK Inc, Samsung C&T (SK hynix/Samsung stake values), Hyosung, LS Corp. MATTERS.

Tokyo was flat-to-lower: Nikkei 225 -0.33% to 63,081.86 on Nov 2 (from 63,290.11, -2.12%, on Fri Oct 30); TOPIX Oct 30 3,965.07 (-0.95%); Nov 2 TOPIX not found. Kioxia fell about 15.8% on a cautious forecast (Tradingkey; direction conflicts across snippets, level is consistent). Friday's rout followed the US AI-capex sell-off: Nasdaq -2.86% on Oct 30 and about -5.3% for October, Intel -22% to -31% (sources conflict) on weak guidance, Amazon down on a $220bn capex forecast (move unverified) (Yahoo live blog, CNBC). Apple reports after the US close tonight (first call under new CEO John Ternus; memory cost is the margin risk) (Yahoo Finance). SoftBank Group (OpenAI-financing sensitivity), Sanken, RS Technologies, MegaChips and Sony are the exposed names; no SoftBank price data was found. MATTERS.

BoJ held at 1.25% (8–1); December hike still live. Takata dissented for 1.5%, arguing underlying inflation has reached 2%; FY2027 core-inflation forecast was raised to 2.6% from 2.4% (ActionForex, Reuters/Yahoo). One low-grade source puts December odds at 68.4%, down from 77.3% (KuCoin; unverified). USD/JPY about 157.7–157.9 with Tokyo reportedly warning on the yen (Saxo; a Vantage headline suggests verbal intervention, page unread).

JGB No. 466 (JP1024661QB1) matured Sunday Nov 1 — decision/confirmation needed today (Section 4). Redemption is expected to settle today (Mon Nov 2); not verified. 10y JGB about 2.77% on Oct 30 (-7bp) (Trading Economics); the "2.22%" figure from last run found no support and should be disregarded. Saxo notes the 10y hit a 30-year high of 3.14% earlier this month (could not verify) — if both are right, the curve has rallied hard.

Company results in the Korean book: Amorepacific Group Q3 operating profit ₩130.1bn (+24.7%), revenue ₩1.207tn (+8.9%) (Amorepacific Group, SBS Biz); Hyosung Corp Q3 operating profit ₩175.3bn (+43.9%), net ₩139.2bn (+63.8%), but -24.3% q/q and Hyosung Chemical swung to a loss (Sat Economy). Stock reactions not found.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** see Section 1. Outlook Report cut growth slightly with upside price risks. Ueda press-conference quotes not found; a preview suggested he signals further hikes toward neutral without back-to-back moves (investinglive). Analysts split between "soft" and "hike bias strengthened."

- **JGBs:** 10y about 2.77–2.80% (ADB showed 2.801% on Oct 26: AsianBondsOnline); 2y 1.893% on Oct 26; 5y and 30y not found this run (last run cited 30y about 3.85%, unverified). Saxo says JGBs rallied Friday.
- **Bank of Korea:** held at 3.00% on Oct 22 after July and August hikes; all six economists polled expect a November hike to 3.25% (Korea Times). Next meeting Nov 26 (prior calendar; not re-confirmed). KRW 1,330–1,340 per dollar (weekly close 1,337.7; not a Nov 2 level). Korea October CPI (about Nov 4) not found; September core was 2.8%.
- **Korea market structure:** nothing dated this week. Background only: Commercial Act treasury-share cancellation rule, duplicate-listing ban being prepared, MSCI developed-market push.
- **US:** Fed held Oct 28 ("hawkish hold"); Bloomberg says a jobs pickup may keep the Fed on track to hike again (Bloomberg). October payrolls Fri Nov 6, consensus about 50–65k, unemployment 4.2% (Kiplinger). Fed funds level quoted as 3.75–4% by one source (suspicious; unverified).

Megacaps / tech (Japan)

- **Advantest (read-through):** Q2 briefing Oct 28 — record quarterly sales/profit, FY forecast raised, new buyback up to 11M shares / ¥280bn (Advantest slides; snippet-level, not opened). Fundamentals strong despite Friday's share-price hit. Tokyo Electron: nothing dated found; reports around Oct 30–Nov 5.
- **SoftBank Group (9984):** no new news found. OpenAI-share-backed margin loan was reported at $10bn (Apr), cut to about $6bn (May); closing status unconfirmed (Bloomberg, TNW). Earnings reported as Nov 10 (not independently confirmed). MATTERS (sentiment-driven).
- **Canon (7751):** Q3 reported Oct 27 — sales +4.9% (record), operating profit +10.3% to ¥97.1bn, net ¥75.2bn (+18.2%); FY sales forecast ¥4,766bn; imaging segment forecast cut ¥10.8bn (Canon IR; PDF snippet only, full-year profit direction unconfirmed). Resolves part of last run's open question. NOISE for this window.
- **Keyence (6861):** Q2 (scheduled Oct 29) results **still not found**. Q1 baseline: operating profit ¥187.1bn, margin 54.0%. Unresolved for the third day; read the release.
- **Sony** (Q2 likely about Nov 10–13, inferred), **Seiko Epson, Omron, Appier, SHIFT, Oro, Optex, MegaChips, RS Technologies, Sanken:** no news found. QUIET/unverified; expect beta to the chip tape.

Banks / financials

- **Sector:** no bank-specific news found. A BoJ hold with a hawkish dissent is mildly supportive. MUFG, Resona, Japan Post expected to report H1 about Nov 5–14 (inferred from last year).
- **SBI Holdings (8473):** H1 results possibly out around now (last year Oct 31); not found. Pre-announced interim dividend about ¥30 (+¥10) (SBI).
- **8524 North Pacific Bank:** Q2 Nov 13 at 14:00 (per prior-run aggregator). 8551 Kita-Nippon: nothing. SMTG, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Fidea, Mitsui Fudosan, Yakult, Shochiku, Universal Entertainment: not found/not searched individually. QUIET/unverified.

Industrials / autos / small-mid caps

- **Suzuki, Honda, Subaru:** Yahoo quote pages show Nov 10 earnings (possibly estimates). Suzuki cut its FY operating-profit forecast to ¥540bn at Q1 (Suzuki IR); Q2 risk persists. Kubota about Nov 9 (unverified).
- **JR Central (9022):** Q2 results **not found** again (aggregators: Oct 28 or 29). Baseline: Q1 operating profit ¥219.2bn (-0.9%); FY3/27 guidance reportedly about -15% (JPX filing, japanstockpulse).
- **Daikin:** H1 likely Nov 5 (last year Nov 5; Nov 3 is a holiday); Q1 was a record (kabuyoho).
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining, Mitsubishi Materials:** H1 expected about Nov 5–10; no buyback/TDnet items found. Copper-sensitive; check.
- **Keisei, JAPEX, Katakura, Tokyotokeiba:** searched, nothing found. QUIET.
- **Nakayama Steel, Hi-Lex, Shibaura Machine, KH Neochem, Ebara Jitsugyo, Fudo Tetra, Obara, Valqua, Tigers Polymer, TOC: not searched this run.** QUIET/unverified; most report Nov 4–14 (aggregator-based).

Korea names

- **Samsung C&T (028260):** Q3 (Oct 28): construction revenue ₩4.465tn, operating profit ₩277bn (+149.5%); fashion ₩20bn (+66.7%); trading ₩99bn or ₩76bn (sources differ); consolidated operating profit ₩1.14tn on revenue ₩12.0tn from a single source (Smart Today, Korea Center, KnowingAsset). Unverified vs DART.
- **Samsung Electronics return plan (context for SC&T/SK Inc):** Q3 revenue ₩195.3tn, operating profit ₩107.4tn; Q3 dividend ₩30tn; up to ₩75tn of the ₩110tn plan remains, timing disputed (January board vs early 2027) (YTN, Korea Center). SK hynix Q3 operating profit ₩83.3tn; its ₩40tn buyback completed early (Inews24; date unconfirmed).
- **Taekwang Industrial (003240):** MATTERS (live), nothing new Oct 30–Nov 2. Company plans a treasury-share holding/disposal/cancellation plan for the 2027 AGM; Trustone says it lacks targets and timing; defamation complaints filed against Trustone (Bizwatch). Q3 likely about Nov 10–14.
- **NAVER (035420):** Q3 Nov 11, 4pm; revenue consensus about ₩3.54tn (KnowingAsset).
- **LS Corp (006260):** no holdco Q3 found; subsidiary LS Electric Q3 (Oct 21) record operating profit ₩233.5bn (+131.7%), backlog about ₩7tn (WikiTree).
- **SK Discovery:** ₩60bn buyback-with-cancellation over three years announced (date unconfirmed) (Smart Today). **SK Inc:** nothing direct; benefits from the SK hynix print.
- **LG Chem pref / LG Corp:** LG Chem reportedly sells 6.54M LG Energy Solution shares (2.79%, about ₩2.5tn) to shore up its balance sheet (Economist; date/link unconfirmed). LGES Q3 preliminary operating profit ₩765bn vs ₩322bn consensus (Oct 8). Relevant to LG Corp NAV.
- **F&F:** no Q3 found; Q2 operating profit ₩86.5bn was 12% below consensus on weak China. Q3 early–mid Nov.
- **LG Electronics pref, ILJIN Holdings, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss:** nothing found; mostly not searched individually. QUIET/unverified; most report Nov 5–14.

3. Probably noise

- **KOSPI Oct 30 sign conflict (-3.53% vs "+3.48%"):** the -3.5% reading to about 5,730 is consistent with Nov 2's +128.34 to 5,859.08; the plus sign is a data-table error.
- **Amazon/Intel/Alphabet one-day move discrepancies (Intel -22% to -31%; Amazon -2% to -12%):** direction agreed, magnitudes differ; no action.
- **Canon Q3:** released Oct 27, already priced.
- **"2.22%" 10y JGB (last run):** unsupported; ignore.
- **Fed funds "3.75–4%" claim in one Korea Times snippet:** looks wrong; unverified.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1) — matured Sun Nov 1, 2026. MOF-confirmed maturity in earlier runs; ISIN→No. 466 mapping remains inferred; today's search found no MOF page on redemption or settlement. Payment on Mon Nov 2 is the standard next-business-day treatment but **unverified**. Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3. **Decisions/actions:** (1) confirm with the custodian that proceeds settled today and the ISIN mapping; (2) reinvest or hold cash — reference 10y about 2.77%, 2y about 1.9%, December BoJ hike odds roughly two-thirds (unverified). **`watchlist-japan.md` needs updating once redemption is confirmed;** the line is retained with a "matured Nov 1" flag today rather than dropped.

*Calendar (= aggregator/inferred/unconfirmed):**

- Nov 2 (tonight): Apple earnings (US); SBI interim*
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed
- Nov 4: Korea October CPI*

- Nov 5: Daikin*; LG Chem Q3*
- Nov 4–6: Shibaura Machine*, Nakayama Steel*, Valqua*, Sony?, *SMM*, Mitsubishi Materials*, KH Neochem*, Ebara Jitsugyo*, Mitsui Fudosan*, Keisei*
- Nov 6: US October payrolls
- Nov 9: Kubota*
- Nov 10: **SoftBank Group**; Suzuki, Honda, Subaru* (Yahoo)
- Nov 11: **NAVER Q3 (4pm)**
- Nov 11–14: MUFG*, Resona*, SMTG*, Kyoto FG*, Fidea*, Japan Post*, Yakult*, Sony*, Taekwang*, SK Inc*, F&F*; **North Pacific Bank Nov 13 14:00**; Kita-Nippon*
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea (hike to 3.25% widely expected for November)

Undated-but-live: AI-capex sentiment and SoftBank/OpenAI financing; Samsung's ₩75tn return decision (January board or early 2027); Taekwang–Trustone; Suzuki Q2 risk; December BoJ hike odds; BoK hike; yen near 158 (intervention-warning zone); LG Chem's LGES share sale.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for the owner.** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (The North Pacific Bank), Q2 Nov 13; 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank. Coverage follows 8551. Please confirm which is held.
2. **JGB JP1024661QB1:** matured Nov 1; ISIN mapping inferred; settlement unverified; line flagged in watchlist.
3. **JR Central:** results still not located.
4. No other identity changes confirmed. Optex (US Optex Systems ≠ 6914) and Samyang (Samyang Holdings 000070 ≠ Samyang Tongsang 002170) risks remain.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm settlement today and ISIN mapping with the custodian; reinvestment plan vs the BoJ outcome and December odds.
- **SoftBank (9984):** Nov 2 close; margin-loan size/LTV; any pre-announcement before Nov 10.
- **Keyence (6861) and JR Central (9022):** locate the Q2 releases and guidance (both unresolved three runs now).
- **Samsung C&T / SK Inc:** Nov 2 closes; whether the SK hynix-vs-Samsung return divergence moves NAV discounts; DART check of SC&T consolidated figures.
- **Hyosung / Amorepacific:** price reactions; Hyosung Chemical loss drivers.
- **LG Corp / LG Chem pref:** confirm the LGES share sale date and use of proceeds.
- **BoJ:** Ueda's press-conference remarks; confirm the 8–1 vote and ETF-sale details from the BoJ release.
- **Taekwang (003240):** DART check for treasury-share or Trustone filings.
- **Unsearched names:** about 10 Japan small/mid caps and 9 Korea small caps need a per-ticker pass; allowing kabutan.jp, release.tdnet.info, dart.fss.or.kr, boj.or.jp, mof.go.jp and company IR hosts would fix most gaps.